



BSc (Hons) in **Information Technology**
Specialized in AI

IT3012 : Intelligent Agents

Year 3 · Semester 1 · 2026 Semester 2

Faculty of Computing

Practical 02

Objective & Lecture Mapping: In Lecture 03, we learned that a mathematically perfect "Table-Driven Agent" is impossible to build due to combinatorial explosion. Instead, we must write Agent Programs. Today, you will implement a **Simple Reflex Agent** using Condition-Action rules, observe its fatal flaws in a partially observable environment, and then upgrade it to a **Model-Based Agent** that maintains an internal memory state.

Part 1: Practical Implementation — Coding the Architectures

Step 1.1: Setting the Trap (Partial Observability)

To see why Simple Reflex agents fail, we must handicap your agent's sensors. We are moving from a Fully Observable world to a Partially Observable one.

1. Open your `visual_grid_game.py` from Lab 01.
2. Locate the `get_percept(self)` method.
3. Modify it so it **no longer returns** the exact global coordinates (`agent_pos`). Instead, it should only return local booleans, e.g., `{ 'wall_ahead': True/False, 'food_here': True/False }` based on checking the adjacent cell in its current facing direction.

Step 1.2: The Simple Reflex Agent (Implementation & Failure)

1. Create a new class called `SimpleReflexAgent` .
2. Implement a `sense_and_act(self, percept)` method that uses strictly IF-THEN logic (Condition-Action rules). *Do not use an `__init__` method to store history.*

Example Logic: IF food_here THEN suck; IF wall_ahead THEN turn_left; ELSE move_forward

3. Run the simulation. **Observe:** Watch the agent get trapped in a corner or a U-shaped wall, infinitely repeating a cycle (e.g., turn left, step forward, hit wall, turn left...).

Step 1.3: The Model-Based Agent (Memory & State)

1. Create a new class called `ModelBasedAgent`.
2. Implement an `__init__(self)` method to initialize an internal memory state (e.g., `self.visited_cells = set()` or a relative movement tracker).
3. In `sense_and_act(self, percept)`, first **update the state** (Transition & Sensor Model) by recording the current percept and the last action taken.
4. Update your IF-THEN rules to query the memory.
Example Logic: IF wall_ahead AND left_is_visited THEN turn_right
5. Run the simulation. **Observe:** The agent should now remember where it has been, realize it is in a loop, and choose an alternate path to escape.

Part 2: Theoretical Evaluation & Lecture Mapping

Based on your practical observations above, answer the following questions to map your code directly to the architectural theories covered in Lecture 02.

1. (Remember) According to Lecture 02, why is it impossible to program a mathematically perfect "Table-Driven Agent" for complex environments like Chess? What happens as the agent's lifetime increases?

A Table-Driven Agent is impossible to use in complex environments like Chess because it must store an action for every possible percept sequence. As the agent's lifetime increases, the number of possible percept sequences grows exponentially (combinatorial explosion). This requires an enormous amount of memory and computation, making it mathematically and practically impossible to implement.

2. (Understand) Look at the code you wrote for your `SimpleReflexAgent`. Identify and explain the specific lines of code that represent the "Condition-Action Rules"

discussed in the lecture.

The Condition-Action Rules in the SimpleReflexAgent are represented by the IF-THEN statements inside the sense_and_act() method.

```
if percept["food_here"]:
    return "suck"
elif percept["wall_ahead"]:
    return "turn_left"
else:
    return "move_forward"
```

3. (Analyze) Your SimpleReflexAgent likely got stuck in an infinite loop during Step 1.2. Based on the lecture, analyze exactly why this happened. How did the combination of "Partial Observability" and a lack of "Percept History" cause this failure?

The SimpleReflexAgent gets stuck in an infinite loop because it only reacts to the current percept and has no memory of previous states. In a partially observable environment, the agent cannot see the entire world, so different locations may produce the same percept. Since it cannot remember where it has already been, it repeatedly performs the same actions, causing endless cycles.

4. (Evaluate) In Step 1.3, you added an internal state to your ModelBasedAgent . Evaluate how your specific code handles the "Transition Model" (how the world evolves) and the "Sensor Model" (how the agent's actions affect the world).

The ModelBasedAgent uses an internal state (such as visited_cells) to remember previously visited locations. This internal memory acts as the basis of the Transition Model, allowing the agent to predict where it has moved after each action. The Sensor Model updates the internal state using the latest percepts, such as detecting walls or food. By combining memory with current percepts, the agent can recognize loops and choose alternative actions, improving its performance in partially observable environments.

Finalize and Lock Lab 02 Documentation

Incomplete: 0/11 questions answered. Please provide detailed responses for all questions.



FACULTY OF COMPUTING